

The Start Your Business Checklist.

The honest first steps to starting your business — **in order**, with the boring-but-critical parts most guides skip left in.

1 Find the real problem FOUNDATION

- ☐ Name the person, the problem, and the result in **one sentence** — before touching colors or a logo.
- ☐ Ask 5 real people how they handle this problem today. Don't pitch — just listen.
- ☐ Write down who this is for, in their own words — not an invented "ideal customer."

2 Shape the first offer FOUNDATION

- ☐ Choose the **one thing** you'll sell first. Everything else is version two.
- ☐ Decide: service (trades your time) or product (works without you) — build accordingly.
- ☐ Price it for what it's worth to the customer, not what feels safe to charge.

3 Make it official OFTEN SKIPPED

- ☐ Pick a name that's easy to say, easy to spell, and won't box you in.
- ☐ Open a **separate business bank account** before your first sale.
- ☐ Confirm what's legally required to launch — licensing, terms, privacy policy.

4 Build the minimum FOUNDATION

- ☐ Build a **minimum viable brand**: one name, one color, one font. Upgrade later.
- ☐ Set a 90-day plan in three blocks — Build, Test, Launch — with one clear checkpoint each.
- ☐ Know your 4 numbers: what you made, what it cost, what's left, how long that lasts.

5 Get your first customers FOUNDATION

- ☐ Treat your first 10 customers as **research**, not just revenue — watch what they do, not just what they say.
- ☐ Review what you learned and adjust the offer before you scale anything.

BEFORE YOU GO FURTHER

This is general educational information, not legal, tax, or financial advice. Verify what applies to your specific business and jurisdiction with a licensed professional before you file, sign, or spend.

Strategy over hype. Foundations over shortcuts.

Save this, work it in order, and revisit it once each phase is real — not just planned.